Policy

Privacy

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide clear guidance about the Quality and Safety Pharmacy Program (QSPP)'s obligations to QSPP registered pharmacies in relation to their data collected for purposes of administering QSPP. QSPP is committed to the principles of ethical, open, and accountable governance.

Privacy

QSPP is bound by the *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth) (**Privacy Act**), the incorporated Australian Privacy Principles (APPs) and obligations of confidentiality in managing the collection, use, storage, and disclosure of personal information, as well as in managing how individuals may access and seek to correct their information, including any personal information, which is held by QSPP. Details of the personal information that we collect, and how it is used, are contained in this Privacy Policy.

By engaging in our QSPP Services and providing us with your personal information and confidential information, you agree to your information being collected, used, stored and disclosed on the terms set out in this Privacy Policy.

In this Privacy Policy:

- "QSPP", "we" and "us" refers to Quality and Safety Pharmacy Program.
- 'You' and 'your' refers to any individual who contacts us in relation to the QSPP Services.
- 'Personal information' has the same meaning given in section 6 of the Privacy Act:
  - *Information or an opinion about an identified individual, or an individual who is reasonably identifiable:*
    - *whether the information or opinion is true or not; and*
    - *whether the information or opinion is recorded in a material form or not.*
- "Confidential information" includes information concerning you and your business that is reasonably considered to be confidential, according to the common law.

The types of personal information we collect and hold

QSPP typically collects the following types of information:

1. Pharmacy name, address, and contact details;
2. Pharmacy ABN;
3. Pharmacy PBS Approval Number;
4. Full name and pharmacist registration number of each of the pharmacy owner/s;
5. Email address and phone number of each of the pharmacy owner/s;
6. Name of any company that owns the pharmacy;
7. Name, email address and pharmacist registration number (where applicable) of the contact person for the pharmacy if that person is not also a pharmacy owner;
8. Training records of pharmacy staff responsible for providing services that are assessed as part of the accreditation process;
9. Any additional email addresses the pharmacy owner/s nominate to receive communications from us; and
10. Communications held between the QSPP staff or assessors and a member of a pharmacy business;
11. Names and contact details (including email address) of any Banner group, Management group or accounting contacts that have authorisation from the pharmacy to communicate with us on their behalf.

We request that all employee records provided to us or our service providers in performing the QSPP Services (including but not limited to offers of employment, letters of termination, position descriptions containing personal information such as staff addresses, contact details and salary) (**Employee Records**) are redacted by the providing party. Employee Records containing identifiable personal information will not be accepted by us or our service providers in performing the QSPP Services.

As at the date of this Privacy Policy, QSPP does not collect sensitive information as defined under the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth), as it is not required for the delivery of QSPP Services. Any documents submitted to QSPP must not contain sensitive information, and pharmacies are responsible for ensuring such data is excluded.

If you do not wish to provide us with particular information, we may not be able to fulfil our assessment.

How we collect your personal information

How we collect your personal information will depend on our relationship or interactions with you.

Directly from you: QSPP collects information directly from pharmacies, individuals or their authorised representatives when providing QSPP Services.

Indirectly: We may also collect your personal information from third parties, such as:

- Banner groups of which you are part of
- Service providers who we contract to assist us in providing the QSPP Services
- Publicly available sources, including social media platforms and other relevant third parties

If you provide us with personal information about other individuals, you are responsible for letting those individuals know that they can find a copy of this Privacy Policy on our website.

Automatically: Whenever you visit or interact with our Website or Customer Portal, we may automatically collect information using technologies such as cookies, pixels, and analytics tools (e.g. Google Analytics). This may include:

- Server and IP address
- Top-level domain name accessed (e.g. .com, .gov, .au)
- Browser type
- Date and time of visit
- The previous website you visited
- If the website has been visited by you before
- Duration of visit

- Pages accessed

This information ('Website Analytics Information") helps us improve user experience, monitor website performance, and tailor our communications.

The personal information we collect is only for purposes directly related to your engagement with the QSPP Services, and only where that use is permitted by the Privacy Act or other legislation. We outline below the types of personal information collected and held by QSPP in providing the QSPP Services and the purposes for which that personal information might be used and disclosed by us.

How we use your personal information

QSPP collects and uses personal information only for those purposes for which it was given to QSPP, or for purposes which are directly related to the QSPP Services, and typically include:

1. to fulfil administrative functions associated with the QSPP Services, including:
   (a) delivery of the QSPP assessment and associated accreditation;
   (b) providing and verifying access to the QSPP Customer Portal, which requires individuals to have their own personal login;
   (c) invoicing, accounting and debt recovery; and
   (d) conducting customer satisfaction and market research surveys.
2. responding to your requests for information and other general inquiries;
3. organising and managing data, and reporting statistical information about the QSPP Services;
4. training and assisting in staff development;
5. receiving services from third party organisations or their employees;
6. providing reports to third party service providers responsible for certification, delivering remuneration and/or services to QSPP-accredited pharmacies;
7. complying with any legislation or regulations as required;
8. for marketing purposes, such as informing you about our activities, events, facilities, and services, and distributing QSPP newsletters to subscribed email addresses; and
9. responding to enquiries and complaints.

How we disclose your personal information

We may be required to disclose your personal information to third parties where necessary to perform the QSPP Services. Examples include disclosure to third party contactors and service providers we use for:

1. conducting QSPP assessments,
2. data processing, data analysis,
3. customer satisfaction surveys,
4. information technology services and support,
5. website maintenance and development, printing, archiving, mail-outs, and market research,
6. secure cloud storage and project management platforms

We do not disclose personal information to data resellers, advertising networks, or social media platforms, as these entities are not involved in the delivery of QSPP services.

We do not give an individual's personal information to other organisations, agencies, or individuals unless:

1. the individual who has provided their personal information (or their authorised representative) has consented for us to do so;
2. the individual who has provided their personal information (or their authorised representative) has consented to, or in our assessment may reasonably expect, that information of the kind they have provided will be given to a third party as a matter of standard practice; or
3. QSPP is obligated or authorised by law to do so.

Where reasonably practical, or where the provision of information to third parties is in our assessment outside the scope of the purposes outlined above, we will provide those individuals with advance notification of, and obtain their informed consent to, the proposed disclosure.

Disclosure of personal information overseas

When we disclose personal information in accordance with this Privacy Policy, it may be accessed from, transferred to, and/or stored outside of Australia. For example, we may disclose your personal information to our third-party Project Management Office (PMO) contractor for the purpose of reviewing and assessing your remedial evidence. PMO personnel may be based in Australia, the Philippines and India. The data protection laws in that country may be of a lower standard than those in Australia. We will, in all circumstances, safeguard your personal information as set out in this Privacy Policy and have taken reasonable steps to ensure that any overseas recipient of your personal information will not breach the APPs in relation to your personal information. If you do not want us to disclose your information to overseas recipients, please let us know.

How we hold and secure your personal information

The security of your information is important to us. Our QSPP website and QSPP Customer Portal are hosted in Australia. If you choose to provide us with personal information, you are consenting to the collection, use, and disclosure of personal information in the manner outlined in this Privacy Policy and the storage of that personal information on our environment hosted in Australia.

We take reasonable steps to ensure your personal information is stored securely and protected from misuse, interference, and loss and from unauthorised access, modification, or disclosure. These steps include:

1. Implementing information security practices aligned with ISO/IEC 27001 and ISO/IEC 27018 standards, including the use of secure applications that prevent unauthorised access or damage to electronically stored information (e.g. requiring user authentication, firewalls, encryption, and anti-virus software).
2. the use of secure databases which require users to be licensed to access. Additional levels of security are adopted which restrict a user's level of access to the database to only that information which is required to perform the user's assigned role;
3. not disclosing information regarding your QSPP accreditation or relationship with us beyond that which is already available in the public sphere or as required by law, without your express consent;
4. seeking written authorisation from pharmacy owner/s before any employees of your pharmacy will be granted QSPP Customer Portal Access, including authorisation as to the level of permission granted in relation to read/write access on your account record types; and
5. using encryption technology to protect data when it is being transferred to our system, and once it is stored on our database.

The information provided to us is stored in electronic databases. In some instances, information may also be stored in physical paper-based files.

Third-party websites

The QSPP website may contain links to third-party websites. These third-party websites are not controlled by QSPP, and QSPP is not responsible for the content, security, or privacy practices of any external sites. We encourage you to read and familiarise yourself with the privacy practices of any third-party websites you visit to understand how they collect and handle your personal information.

Based on your interactions with our website, Google and third-party sites may elect to show you content and advertising that directs back to our website.

Cookies

A cookie is a small text file stored in your device for a pre-defined period of time. QSPP may use cookies to collect non-personal information such as the date, time, or duration of your visit to our website, or the pages accessed, and your browser type. This information helps us administer the website, analyse usage patterns, and improve your experience. Cookies used on the QSPP website do not and cannot infiltrate a user's hard drive to access or collect personal or confidential information and stored on the user's device.

You can manage or disable cookies through your browser settings. However, in doing so, you may be unable to access certain pages or content on our website.

We use Google Analytics and other media publishers to advertise our products and services online. Third party vendors use cookies to display relevant ads based on your past visits to our websites. Information and data collected through Google Analytics is stored by Google on servers in Belgium, Chile, Denmark, Finland, Ireland, Singapore, Taiwan and the United States of America.

You can opt out of the collection of information via Google Analytics by downloading the Google Analytics Opt-out browser add on. You can also change the settings in your browser to control how your browser deals with cookies. However, in doing so, you may limit the functionality of each of our websites and be unable to access certain pages or content on our website.

How we use and disclose your personal information for direct marketing

We may use or disclose your personal information for the purpose of marketing, informing you about our services, upcoming promotions and events, or other opportunities that may interest you. If you do not want to receive direct marketing communications, you can opt-out any time by using the opt-out means that will accompany every communication of this kind.

If you opt-out of receiving marketing material from us, we may still contact you in relation to our ongoing relationship with you.

We will not disclose your personal information to third parties for marketing purposes without your consent.

How we retain and dispose of your personal information

QSPP retains personal information only for as long as it is required to fulfil the purposes for which it was collected, or as required by law. When personal information is no longer needed, QSPP takes reasonable steps to securely destroy or de-identify the information in accordance with applicable legal and regulatory obligations.

Information stored electronically is deleted using secure methods, and physical records are disposed of through confidential destruction processes.

How to access, update and correct your personal information

You are entitled to request access to your personal information that we hold about you and/or to make corrections to that information or destroy your personal information as appropriate. If you would like to request access to, or correct your personal information, please contact us using the contact details set out at the end of this document.

We will allow access or make the requested changes unless we consider there is a sound reason under the Privacy Act or other relevant law to withhold the information or not make the requested change.

If we refuse your access or correction request, we will provide you with a written notice setting out the reasons for our refusal and how you can make a complaint to the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner as outlined below.

Making a complaint about the handling of your personal information

QSPP regards privacy as an important part of the relationship we have with our QSPP accredited pharmacies and applicants for accreditation. You may contact us at any time if you have any questions, concerns or complaints about this Privacy Policy or about the way in which your personal information is handled.

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Changes to this Privacy Policy

We may amend this Privacy Policy from time to time to reflect our current data collection and disclosure practices, with or without notice to you. The most recent version of our Privacy Policy is available on our website. We recommend that you visit our website regularly to keep up to date with any changes to this Privacy Policy.

How to contact us

Please address any complaint about privacy to the Privacy Officer via email to support@qspp.com or mail to:

Privacy Officer
PO Box 310
Fyshwick, ACT, 2609

We take all complaints seriously and will respond to your complaint within a reasonable period.

If you are not satisfied with our handling of your complaint, you may contact the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner (**OAIC**). The OAIC can be contacted by telephone on 1300 363 992, by email enquiries@oaic.gov.au or by using the contact details on the OAIC website.